Chapter 2

The Honey and the Flies

SUMMARY. When the god G!ara was still on the earth, he wanted to imitate the cardinal woodpecker by chopping out honey from a hive high in a tree. But he did not have the whistling magic or the ability to fly possessed by the woodpecker, so he fell to the ground and his stomach burst. Flies came and sewed up his stomach, and G!ara thanked the flies.

SPEAKER. *Dahm Ti N!a'an*

RECORDED. Kauri, Botswana, 1971

TRANSCRIBED BY. *|Ui Charlie N!aici, G‡kao Martin |Kaece*

haa
he
ǁ'aixa n!a'an
the god
ǁ'aixa n!a'an
the god
he ju ko ha te o G!ara, ha hin tsi gǁxun n!ore
people say that he is G!ara, the one who created the earth
te ha !'aun!'aun
and the cardinal woodpecker
ku ǁxan cu zo
was looking around for honey
ǁxan cu zo te ha !'aun!'aun tsi ho zo te-u ǁohm
he was looking around for honey and the cardinal woodpecker found the honey and was chopping it

ku ǁohm hi te ha tsi g|ae n|ang
was chopping then he (G!ara) came and sat down
te n|ang te ku g‡araa ha ko hi
he sat and asked him for it
te ha ǁohm hi, ǁohm hi, ǁohm hi, ǁohm hi, ǁohm hi te ǁauhn
and he chopped it, chopped it, chopped it, chopped it, chopped it and whistled
ǁauhn ha tcisa ha !aro, ke sin tan-ǀ'osi
he whistled up the things he was carrying on a pole, and flat dishes
te ka !'aan te ha ǂ'haan hi ko ǁ'akoa
they flew up to him and he put the honey in them
ǂ'han hi,ǂ'han hi te ǁ'oana hi !aroa te tsaua ha te g|ae u
put it in them, put it in them and put the carrying pole of honey over his shoulder and left him and went off
te ǁa'i n|ui cete
and one day again
ha G!ara cete u
G!ara again went
te tsi g|ae ho hi te-u ǁohm
and he came and found it and was chopping it
te ha !'aun!'aun tsi g|ae n|ang
and the cardinal woodpecker came and sat down
ee, ha ǁohm hi, ǁohm hi, ǁohm hi
yes, he chopped it, chopped it, chopped it
te ko ha ni ǂoa, ko ha ni ǂoa tca !'aun!'aun goaq oo, n|ang
and he tried to imitate, tried to imitate what the woodpecker had done, but
ǁauhn tama tcisi te ko ka !'an n|ang ha ǁ'oana hi u
failed to whistle up the things so they would come up to him so that he could carry them on his shoulders and leave
te ka !xau te sin n|huia ha |kaisi ko ka te
but they refused so he just climbed down the tree and
te tsi ǂxuru te !'an ǂ'han hi
and then climbed back up and went and put it in
te ǁ'oanaa ǁ'akoa
and put it over his shoulder there
te ko ha ni ku tsau te ǁxoaǁxoaraa ǁ'akoa te tsi ǂaeh te ha g!u !hara
and tried to fly but fell down and when he hit the ground, his stomach burst
ha !'aun!'aun tsi ǂaeh n|hui hi tciasi te !auh
the cardinal woodpecker came and took the honey things and left
ee, mama
yes, mother
te ha g!u !hara te ha sin cu te
and his stomach split and he just lay there and

si!a tsi ǂaeh ǁkaea ha
they all came and gathered around him
te ku nǂom ha g!u te ku nǂom ha g!u
and worked on his stomach and worked on his stomach
te si!a !xare tsi ǂaeh sin n!ai ka ha tjin
and others came and just bit him until he cried
a re ca !'han zoaqzoaq wa?
do you know flies?
ee,mama, tcimhsa to'a tzeamh he o zoaqzoaq
yes, mother, those little things here that are flies
ǁ'a zoaqzoaq tsi g|ae
those flies came
g|ae gǁxun ha g!au san to'a ha khoetca n!un ka 'inhin
lay his hands there as if standing and doing like this
tzanǂhao te ku g!ai ha
concentrated on sewing his
tchin|ho te g!ai, g!ai, g!ai te g!ai ǁkae te ha ui ha te ko: "Ee, mi tsuma gu mi"
midriff and sewed, sewed, sewed and sewed it together and he thanked him and said "Yes, my nephew, take me up"
ha koe tsau kxui , ee
that's how he got up, yes
mama ee
mother, yes
tca sa koh du tsi to'a
that's how they have been doing things